

Farhan Syed

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Professional Summary

Skilled Network and former System Engineer with **8+ years' experience** specializing in complex Information Technology (IT) systems, Network Security, Risk Management, Penetration Testing & Vulnerability Assessments. Committed to staying updated on Computer Science, Web technologies, Technology & Innovation, Data Analytics, AI/ML and Cybersecurity/Information Security trends.

Education

Master of Science: Cybersecurity

University of Houston

GPA: 3.85/4.0

May 2024

Houston, TX

Bachelor of Engineering: Electronics & Communications Engineering

Osmania University

GPA: 3.5/4.0

May 2014

Hyderabad, India

Certifications & Courses

CompTIA Security+, Certified Ethical Hacker (CEHv11), Microsoft AZ-900, Cisco CCNA, Palo Alto PCCSA, Fortinet NSE2, Autopsy Digital Forensics

Skills

- **Identity & Access Management:** Active Directory, CyberArk, SailPoint, Azure AD, Single Sign-On (SSO), Multi Factor Authentication (MFA), Role Based Access Control (RBAC), Lightweight Directory Access Protocol (LDAP)
- **Threat Detection & Incident Response:** Splunk Enterprise, Azure Sentinel, Wireshark
- **Cloud Security:** Azure Security Center, Azure Sentinel, Azure Key Vault, AWS
- **Networking:** Cisco routers & switches (Catalyst, Meraki), Palo Alto & Fortinet firewalls, IPv4, IPv6, TCP/IP, LAN/WAN, NAT, ACLs, OSI Model, VPN, Subnetting, Routing Protocols: BGP, OSPF, EIGRP, EGP, RIP, IGRP, Software-Defined Networking (SDN)
- **Other Tools:** Nmap, Nessus (Vulnerability assessment), Autopsy, Snort, Metasploit, Burp Suite, Zeek, Brim
- **Frameworks:** NIST CSF, HIPAA, PCI-DSS, ITIL, SOC 2, Sarbanes-Oxley Act, FINRA, MITRE ATT&CK, COBIT
- **Platforms & Operating Systems:** Microsoft Azure, Office 365, Windows OS, MacOS, Windows Server, Kali Linux
- **Ticketing Systems:** ServiceNow
- **Scripting & Coding Languages:** Python, Bash, PowerShell, HTML5, SQL, JavaScript, C/C++
- **Penetration Testing:** TryHackMe
- **Other Skills:** Troubleshooting issues, Service Desk, Hardware, Analytical Skills, Problem Solving, Attention to detail, Self-Motivated, Customer Service, Project Management (Agile, Kanban), API Security

Experience

Network Engineer

The Econsortium Group Inc.

Jul 2024 – Present

Houston, TX- USA

- Designed, implemented, and managed network infrastructure as a part of a team in a fast-paced MSP environment, executed network cutovers, optimizing performance and improving security for their customers.
- Successfully configured and maintained Cisco Switches, Fortigate firewalls, CradlePoint firewalls, VPNs, and security appliances, protecting network boundaries while reducing security risks by 80% in an OT environment.
- Monitored network traffic for anomalies, resulting in the identification and resolution of all critical incidents.
- Conducted regular security audits and vulnerability assessments, reducing the company's attack surface and ensuring compliance with industry standards.
- Developed, enforced and migrated network security policies, safeguarding sensitive data and achieving 90% reduction in potential breaches in both IT and OT environments.
- Responded to network incidents, troubleshooting and resolving network issues with an average resolution time of 1.5 hours, minimizing downtime and operational impact.
- Collaborated with cross-functional IT teams to integrate security measures into new and existing network designs, reducing network security vulnerabilities by 80%.
- Stayed updated on emerging security threats and technologies, proactively monitoring and implementing advanced measures to strengthen network defenses.

Senior Systems & Security Engineer

Al Qasabi Contracting Company

Sep 2021 - Jul 2022

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

- Researched, conducted root cause analysis & created IT Infrastructure security strategies, participated in collaborative decision-making with stakeholders, providing increased efficiency & an effective budget with excellent time management.
- Implemented innovative business process improvement for technical proposal writing, documentation to apply upgrades with status reports, which created a 25% efficiency save, resulting in overall organizational growth & excellent feedback.
- Supervised ERP system architecture & Identity access management, while collaborating with cross-functional teams & developers in a fast-paced environment and ensured 100% compliance with commercial, regulatory, legal, industry best practices, recommendations & quality assurance policies and guidelines outlined by Saudi Arabia's Vision 2030, Saudi Arabian Monetary Agency, and Essential Cybersecurity Controls (ECC) by the National Cybersecurity Authority.

- Saved the firm from surplus costs by an estimated 10% by liaison & relationship management with product vendors, handling software licensing procurement & inventory, while effectively utilizing collaboration & organizational skills.
- Deployed & executed backup processes & DRP management solutions achieving business resilience.
- Deployed Splunk SIEM: log monitoring, data visualization & analytics to institute Defense in Depth organization wide.

System & Network Administrator

Apr 2017 - Sep 2021

Al Qasabi Contracting Company

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

- Achieved a 70% efficiency increase by installing applications & configuring endpoints, routers, switches, NGFW firewalls, workstations, printers, servers, CCTV, using networking & assisting with incident management & disaster recovery.
- Implemented SSL VPN, Proxy, IPSEC, TLS, to connect offices securely, by switching, routing & TCP/IP knowledge.
- Transformed ERP/Finance/Accounting operations by 100%, utilizing MS .NET framework, SQL databases & VB for on-premises solution while moving to SaaS through coordinated efforts with software developers in development & testing.
- Promoted employee awareness by preparing presentations, training, user guides & knowledge bases with Microsoft Office 365 tools like Word, Excel, PowerPoint, using strong interpersonal, written & verbal communication skills.
- Lead team, ensuring endpoints (operating systems: Linux, Windows), networks availability, reliability, patching, logging, integration, optimization, performance & continuous improvement of user experience, using teamwork & leadership skills.

Jr. Systems Engineer

Jan 2016 – Dec 2016

Meinhardt Arabia

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

- Designed a large-scale network & security program for the Ministry of Interior's \$1.5 billion KAP-5 project, leading to approval, required for the execution phase of the project.

Jr. Systems Engineer

Jan 2015 - Dec 2015

Smart Cube Inc

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

- Designed & implemented Home-based automation, IoT & security network projects and surpassed client expectations.

Telecom Field Test Engineer

Aug 2014 - Dec 2014

LCC - A Tech Mahindra Company

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

- Conducted comprehensive drive tests using specialized tools and equipment to measure and collect data and analyzed key performance indicators (KPIs) such as signal strength, call drops, handovers, and data throughput and generated detailed reports.

Academic Projects

- Was involved in a text mining analysis project on Topic Modelling at University of Houston, examining media portrayal of terrorist organizations. Applied Python, adhered to ACL best practices, and produced an impactful report on findings.
- Executed impactful text analysis and NLP project, optimizing pipelines by implementing advanced techniques on large datasets. Achieved optimized results through data preprocessing, revealing insights into word distributions and the impact of stop words. Identified common words and n-grams, showcasing expertise in deriving meaningful insights from unstructured text data.
- Leveraged Open-Source Intelligence (OSINT) to build a profile about an Iranian threat actor/APT group dubbed APT33 aka Elfin and submitted a report about findings.
- Implemented Decision Tree and Random Forest Algorithms for Network Intrusion Detection, achieving ~99% accuracy, precision, and F1 score on the KDDcup 1999 dataset in CIS6397-Data Analytics for Cybersecurity.
- Presented to and engaged with an audience of 60 people about critically analyzing the trends and technologies in Cybersecurity and Cyberwar.

Affiliations

- Student Member at ISSA, WiCys & IEEE

Languages & Additional Information

- English, Urdu, Hindi, Arabic, German, Spanish, Turkish
- Eligibility: Eligible to work in the US for internships and full-time for up to 36 months on F1-OPT.